TOP SCENT CODES

This season's fragrance palette is shaped by three major directions

- **Aquatic Freshness**
  Ocean mist, sea salt, marine accords
- **Citrus Clarity**
  Mandarin, bergamot, grapefruit
- **Green Softness**
  Vetiver tea, fig leaf, basil
- **Gentle Florals**
  Lavender, mogra, chamomile

reimagined with a modern sensibility that's lighter, refined and suited to contemporary homes," says Patil. This evolution reflects a broader lifestyle shift, which is rooted in tradition, but globally aware.

Not all fragrance formats, though, perform equally well for the Indian summer. Heat can amplify scent, making controlled diffusion essential. Climate matters as much as preference. So, experts suggest reed diffusers, which are consistent, low-maintenance scents; room mists for instant freshness on demand, and essential oil diffusers that help adjust intensity. Candles remain popular, but most recommend clean-burning soy wax and mindful placement away from direct sunlight.

Fragrance as Decor

A part of visual storytelling, scent today is as much about how a space looks as how it feels. From sculptural candles to minimal glass diffusers, fragrance formats, therefore, are doubling as design objects.

COMMON MISTAKES TO AVOID

- **Choosing overly strong scents for small spaces**
- **Mixing conflicting fragrance profiles**
- **Ignoring airflow and placement**
- **Overusing multiple formats at once**

According to Arushi Agrawal, founder and director, SEVA Home, a brand which makes luxury home fragrances, "Fragrance should follow the same design logic as interiors. In minimal spaces, scents sit quietly in the background. In layered interiors, they can add complexity, but always in balance."

In summer, when spaces are more pared back, these elements become more visible. Their material, proportion, and finish start to matter just as much as the scent.

Building Mood across Rooms

Layering, at the same time, is emerging as a sophisticated way to create a cohesive home experience. "One simple approach is to start with a main fragrance in the living room and keep adjoining spaces lighter. The bedroom can then transition into softer, calming notes," suggests Jain.

The key, experts say, is subtlety: staying within one fragrance family or sharing a common base note to avoid sensory overload. A living room can have fresh, welcoming, citrus or aquatic notes, bedroom can make use of calming lavender, musk or chamomile, and dining or hallways can do with soft green or neutral florals.

Less but better stands out as the new fragrance philosophy. Agrawal adds, "People are no longer layering aggressively. They are choosing fewer, better scents that evolve gently through the day."

The modern summer home, therefore, is no longer heavily scented, but makes you feel at ease in your own space. And that is the real trend: fragrance as quiet comfort.